

DAMAGE, DEATH, & HEALING

Additionally, Stunned individuals cannot properly defend themselves and their Physical, Mental, and Physical Defenses all drop to zero — with the exception of worn gear or other points gained outside of Stats.

Characters who are Stunned lose at least one Round to the effect. To get rid of a Stun Effect, the Character must make an Endurance or Will Check, whichever is higher, on the turn following their Stun. The Success Number is 8 and you must make at least 3 Successes in a single Check. Success indicates that you have shaken off the Stun and may act normally on your next Round. Failure indicates that you are still Stunned and must repeat the process in the subsequent Round.

Optional: Being Stunned can be a big impediment during a fight. If your campaign style is invested in deeper realism during combat, you can add an optional Stun rule to help simulate the devastating effects of real world combat. Any time a Character takes more Damage to their Body in a single Round than their Endurance Stat, they are at risk of being Stunned. For example, if a Character has an Endurance of 3 and they take 4

points of Body Damage, they risk being Stunned. The Character immediately makes an Endurance Check with a Success Number of 8. Unless they gain at least 3 Successes, they are Stunned. Be aware that this will greatly increase the deadliness of Combat.

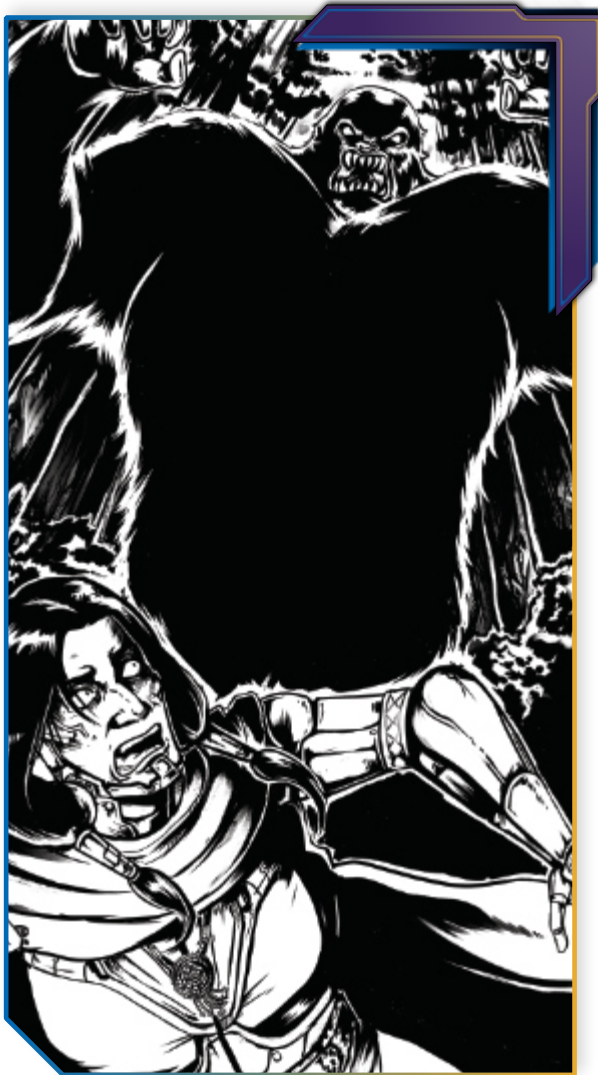
Burning

Burning begins the turn after Fire Damage is taken. When something causes the Burning Effect as the result of Fire Damage, the victim will suffer additional Fire Damage equal to the Rank of the Fire (see Fire Damage) at the end of their turn each Round. There is no roll for this, the victim simply takes the Damage. If the victim chooses to spend their Primary Action attempting to extinguish whatever is causing the Fire Damage or to get out of the area that is burning, they can make a Survival Skill Check. If they get a number of Successes equal to or greater than the Rank of the Fire Damage, they extinguish it and will not take further Damage. If a Character has access to complete immersion in water or the equivalent, they can spend their Primary Action to extinguish the Fire without making a Dice Check.

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States

The default state of Characters in Coyote & Crow is Conscious, but that's hardly descriptive of all of the states humans can be in. Unless called out otherwise, all Characters are assumed to be Conscious — that is, fully aware and able to make thoughtful decisions and choices.



Sleeping

By default, Characters are assumed to be able to sleep well, get the rest they need, and can enter this state when needed. Gifts and Burdens, drugs, danger, stress, anxiety, and the environment may all impact whether a person gets enough sleep. Failing to get enough sleep can eventually lead to exhaustion. When a Character is Sleeping, they cannot take any Actions (Primary or Secondary), except to wake up (which is a Secondary Action). They may only take this Action by choice if there's an outside influence, like a noise or an ally waking them. Any Character Sleeping is automatically subject to Surprise.

Altered

Altered is an umbrella term used to describe a wide variety of States. It covers many forms of consciousness outside what we prescribe as standard consciousness. The effects are extremely varied, but usually take the form of temporary Stat gains and losses, often in balance. There are many ways to achieve Altered States: Prayer, ceremonies, drugs, spirits, and meditation, to name a few.

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More specific Altered States will be covered in future Coyote & Crow materials.

Panic

Sometimes fear or other stimuli can drive a person to Panic. They lose all ability to make rational decisions and often act in misguided ways out of a sense of immediate preservation. Sometimes Panic can affect Characters through an Ability, but Panic is more often caused by very common fears and anxiety. When a Character is subject to Panic, they must make a Will Check to overcome it. However, the number of Successes needed can depend on the scale of the situation. In general, Player Characters should not be subject to Panic outside of Abilities or specific effects. NPCs, though, can be subject to Panic any time the Story Guide sees fit. Avoiding Panic during a fight involving ranged weapons or inside a burning house might require 2 Successes. Waking up to see a Kalo Kayaki over your bed, leering down at you might be 5 Successes. If a Character Critically Fails a Panic Check, they fall Unconscious.

The effect of Panic is that the Character can still take Actions, both Primary and Secondary. However, the Character must act in accordance with immediate self-preservation. No other considerations are possible. If fleeing is possible, the Character may flee. They may freeze and take no actions at all. They may attack and the target of the attack may not even be the source of the Panic, but instead someone considered in the way of the panicked person's survival. Characters cannot operate unfamiliar machinery, make complex decisions, or do anything that doesn't in some way help to alleviate the Characters' Panic.

If you're a Player Character, you should play out your Panic as you see fit with Story Guide approval.

There are two ways the Panic Effect can end. The first is that the Character overcomes it. Once they have become Panicked, on subsequent Rounds they can attempt to overcome their own Panic and get control. This is tough to do. Panicked people often stay that way. As a Secondary Action, anyone suffering from Panic may make a Will Check. If they get Successes equal

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to or greater than the Rank of the Panic, then they overcome it and on the following Round can act normally. The Success Number needed varies. If the source of the Panic can still be seen and heard, it's 9. If the source of the Panic is out of sight or hearing but still present in general, it's 8. If the source of the Panic is gone or removed entirely, the Success is 6.

The second way Panic can end is that either the source of the panic is removed from the scenario entirely — a fire is extinguished, an enemy defeated, a spirit banished — or the person Panicked is removed. This might mean they get far enough away that the Story Guide thinks that the Character is no longer in danger, or perhaps the Character is rendered Unconscious.

Unconsciousness

At a certain point the human body, mind, and spirit reach their limits. When you are pushed too far, eventually you break. When a Character reaches zero Body, Mind, or Soul, they may fall Unconscious. Between Damage, Fo-

cus, Fortitude, Healing, Abilities, and Resting, there are many ways to lose and gain Body, Mind, and Soul.

Every Round that a Character has zero or less in Body, Mind, or Soul, they must make a Will Check to stay Conscious. The Character needs 1 Success with a Success Number of 8. If they make the Check, then they are Conscious but may only take Secondary Actions. Once Unconscious, a Character will stay Unconscious until Body, Mind, and Soul are all at a minimum of 1.

If a Character is Unconscious at the end of an Encounter, the Character automatically begins a Short Rest unless otherwise decided by the Story Guide.

An Unconscious Character receives no sensory information and cannot take any Actions, Primary or Secondary. Their Endurance, Agility, Wisdom, Perception, Will and Charisma no longer contribute to their Defenses.

A Character regains consciousness when their Body, Mind, and Soul are at least at 1.

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Stat Damage

Occasionally, a weapon or situation will call for Stat Damage. Stat Damage is always the last Damage to be taken during an attack. Apply all other Damage first. The type of Damage being dealt will determine which chart below is used. Once Damage type is determined, the Player whose Character is receiving the Stat Damage will roll a die. The die result will drop the corresponding Stat by 1 point. Once it is lowered, the Character's Derived Stats are recalculated and new maximums are determined. If the Character was already at their max, this may

mean the Character also loses a point of Body, Mind, or Soul when they adjust to their new lower number. For example, say a Character with a Body of 10 lost a point of Endurance. This would also lower their Body Score of 10 to 9.

Stat Damage heals far more slowly than traditional Damage. See the section on Healing for more. Stats cannot be reduced below 1. If a situation calls for a Stat to be reduced that is already at 1, the situation may result in Death or Instant Death at the Story Guide's discretion.

Physical Damage	Roll	Mental Damage	Roll	Spiritual Damage	Roll
Strength	1-2	Strength	1	Strength	1
Agility	3-4	Agility	2	Agility	2
Endurance	5-6	Endurance	3	Endurance	3
Intelligence	7	Intelligence	4-5	Intelligence	4
Perception	8	Perception	6-7	Perception	5
Wisdom	9	Wisdom	8-9	Wisdom	6
Spirit	10	Spirit	10	Spirit	7-8
Charisma	11	Charisma	11	Charisma	9-10
Will	12	Will	12	Will	11-12

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Dying

Anytime a Character has less than zero points of Body, Mind, or Soul, they are said to be Dying. This is certainly trouble for a Player, but there are plenty of ways that they can avert their Character's final end.

First things first. If a Character is Dying, they also fall under the rules for Unconsciousness. Being Conscious or Unconscious does not affect whether a Character is Dying.

Regardless whether it is during an Encounter or during Narrative play, when a Player's Character is Dying, it becomes an Encounter. That is because each Round, a Player will have to make certain rolls that affect their fate.

Every Round during the Character's turn, they make a Reaction Roll for each Derived Stat (Body, Mind, and Soul) below zero to determine what happens next in regards to their Dying state. This Dice Check is based on either their Will or their Endurance, the

Player can choose, regardless of which Derived Stat is below zero. The Success Number is 8. After the Check, consult the following table:

- » **Critical Failure: Lose 2 points**
- » **Failure: Lose 1 point**
- » **1+ Success: No Change**
- » **1+ Critical Success: Stabilized**

Lose 2 Points indicates that the Player is continuing to worsen. They take 2 points of Damage in the appropriate category (Body, Mind, or Soul). If this reduces them to the point where they would die, see Death. Otherwise, they will continue to be Dying in the next Round.

Lose 1 Point indicates that the Player is continuing to worsen. They take a point of Damage in the appropriate category (Body, Mind, or Soul). If this reduces them to the point where they would die, see Death. Otherwise, they will continue to be Dying in the next Round.

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No change indicates that the Character is still in a Dying state and they will have to make another Check the following Round. There is no other effect.

Stabilized indicates that the appropriate Stat (Body, Mind, or Soul) has stabilized, the Player does not have to make additional Checks in subsequent Rounds, and that they are no longer considered Dying if this was their only Derived Stat below zero. They do not gain or lose any more points unless they take Damage from a subsequent attack.

If another Character spends a Primary Action to make a First Aid Check on a Dying Character and gets any Successes, the Character does not lose any Body points that Round. If the Character making the First Aid Check gets a Critical Success, the Character stabilizes and does not need further medical attention to keep from dying. If the Character attempting the Skill Check gets a Critical Failure, they do a point of Body Damage to the subject. It is important to note that First Aid only affects Body. Only a Dying Character can Stabilize themselves from loss of Mind and Soul.

Death

Death is a big event in Coyote & Crow, as it is in real life. You may have noticed that in the above descriptions that there is a long road for a Player's Character to get to the point where they may die. There is a lot one can do, from Fortitude and Focus, to holding out for quite a while while dying, to fairly easy First Aid Checks, in order to keep from reaching death's door.

For non-Player Characters, it will be up to the Story Guide how to proceed. Some Story Guides may choose to gloss over things like Dying and Stabilizing for non-Player Characters. They may just declare them defeated or dead. Others may wish to give every opportunity for other Characters to jump in and save those lives. That level of detail will be decided by your Story Guide and by the tone and tenor of your Saga.

When it comes to Player Characters, one very important rule presides over all the rules of this Chapter. **A Player's Character doesn't die unless their Player allows it.** Player Character death is the biggest event in this game. It irrevocably changes the experi-

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ence for that Player and it would not be fair to anyone at the table if the Player didn't have some agency in that situation. Some could argue that the Player had agency in the choices that led to their Character's death, by the very definition of their control over their Character. We would agree, if this game was a simulation of real life. But it's not. It's about epic heroes and their journeys. Players and Story Guides together should decide when that journey comes to an end.

Now, of course, you are welcome to override this rule and play your Saga however you would like. If you choose to do so, we ask that your entire group discuss this rule before you start playing and decide how you want to proceed in the case of Character death before it happens.

Sometimes unlucky rolls or a powerful opponent can kill a Character. Sometimes poor choices put a Character at risk. Or maybe a Player is moving away or can no longer play in the group and the Player and the Story Guide have decided to bring the Character's story to a close. No matter what has led to a Player Character death, that final note should be

something that the Player is involved with.

If the numbers and the dice suggest that a Character should die but the Player doesn't want their Character's story to end, maybe this is a chance for the Story Guide to introduce a new Character or story element, one that helps save the Character at the last second, creating a dramatic moment.

Or maybe the dice aren't going that badly but a Player has decided they want to retire their Character. They have worked it out with their Story Guide that they want the Character to go out in a moment of triumph, saving their friends. In that case, forget what the dice say and let the Character go out like a hero.

If a Player is leaving your group and decides they want their Character to die, then that's the end of things. If the Player is staying in the group however, set aside a time with the Story Guide after the current Session to help create a new Character and reintroduce the Player into the game with their new Character in the following Session.

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Instant Death

Optionally, non-Player Characters can die before they reach the minimums of negative Body, Mind, or Soul equal to the Characters Endurance, Wisdom, or Will. In these cases, the Character has simply suffered too much immediate trauma to survive. Instant Death can happen in the following circumstances:

- When an NPC is Dying and makes a Critical Failure while attempting to Stabilize.
- When a minor NPC is hit with a “12” on a Critical Die from a Player Character.
- When the Story Guide determines there is no reason to think a Character could survive the situation — for example, they fell hundreds of feet into rocky surf.

Instant Death isn't common. When it happens, it should either be because taking the time to do all of the bookkeeping would slow down the pace of the game unnecessarily or because the death serves a dramatic storytelling purpose.

Resting and Healing

So far, we've talked about many ways Characters can sustain injuries, the many ways they can be negatively affected, and even how they can die. Now it is time to focus on healing. Healing, resting, and gaining Mind, Body, and Spirit are an important part of Coyote & Crow. Unlike some games that have the health of a Character denoted by a single number, you will have noticed by now that Coyote & Crow has broken it down into three different numbers (Body, Mind, and Spirit). This is intentional and significant. These three aspects are all equally important and vital, yet they are distinct from each other while remaining intertwined. Healing involves not just broken bones and cuts, but the mental faculties and the very essence of the Character.

This section will discuss how Characters can regain lost Body, Mind, Spirit and recover Damage taken to their Stats. We'll reiterate here that Body can never go above its original value unless something specifically states that it can raise the number beyond that limit. If your Character's starting Body is 8, no amount of healing or rest will raise it above

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8. Mind and Spirit do not have the same limitations. They can go above their normal limits in a number of ways. However, it's important to note that most of these gains are temporary and that Mind and Spirit will return to their normal maximums after a Long Rest.

There are five ways that a Character can regain lost Mind, Body, and Spirit:

- Various Skills (Medicine, Ceremony, etc)
- Abilities
- Drugs
- Short Rest
- Long Rest

In this section, we'll only be covering the Short Rest and Long Rest options. The others will be covered in detail in their specific entries in their respective Chapters.

Short Rest

Your Encounter has ended. You survived, but you're a little rough around the edges. Time for a break. A Short Rest is exactly what it sounds like. Short Rests take place outside of Encounters and are only used during Narrative

Play. Your Story Guide will determine the amount of time it takes, if necessary. It might be five minutes or it might be an hour.

During a Short Rest, Characters should be, well, resting. You can still make Dice Checks at the Story Guide's discretion, but they shouldn't be demanding in any way. A Short Rest is enough time for everyone to catch their breath, have a meal, bandage other's wounds and their own, and contemplate what got them into their current situation.

Certain Skills, like Ceremony or Medicine, cannot be done during a Short Rest. They require too much focus and time. If a Skill doesn't specify if it can be done during a Short Rest, check with your Story Guide.

The Story Guide may interrupt the Short Rest with another Encounter. If this is the case, the Characters do not gain the benefits from a Short Rest and must start over after the subsequent Encounter ends.

So what does a Short Rest accomplish? Each Character in a Short Rest makes three Checks upon completion of the Short Rest; an Endurance Check, a Wisdom

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Check, and a Will Check. Every Success gained on those rolls returns one point of corresponding Body, Mind, and Spirit.

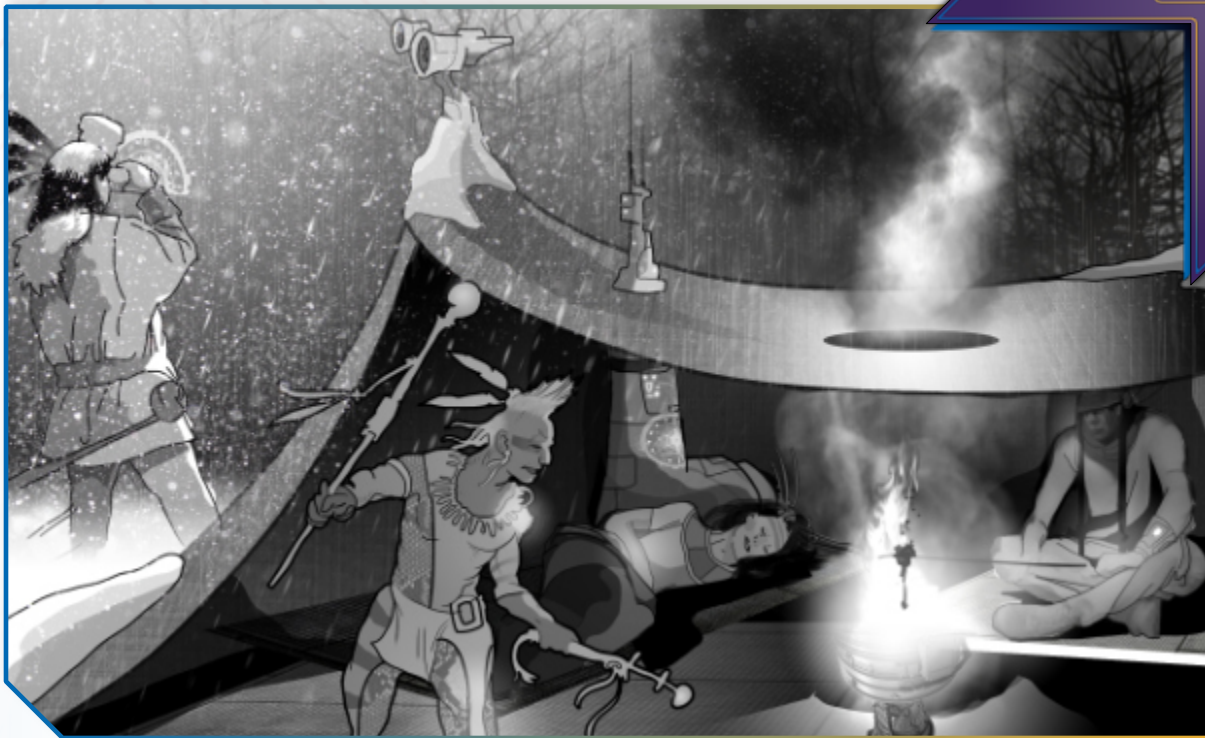
Short Rests can only be taken a maximum of twice a day, and can only be taken after an Encounter. In other words, if you don't have an Encounter, you can't take a Short Rest. If you only have one Encounter, you can only take one Short Rest.

Long Rest

As with a Short Rest, a Long Rest isn't an exact amount of time, but is generally at least enough time

to sleep, eat, bathe, and change clothes. It may be longer if there are other things that the Characters want to do during that same period, such as a Ceremony. Note that a Long Rest doesn't necessarily have to include sleep. As with Short Rests, if they are interrupted by an Encounter, you do not gain the full benefit. It is up to your Story Guide to determine if you gain the full benefits, only the benefits of a Short Rest, or no benefits at all. Characters may only take one Long Rest per day.

Characters must be Conscious or Sleeping to take a Long Rest. Many Skills and Abilities can also



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be activated during a Long Rest. See their individual descriptions for details.

A Long Rest allows for the regaining of Body, Mind and Spirit. A Character that has taken a Long Rest makes Checks, as with a Short Rest. In addition to the gains listed in a Short Rest, the Character taking a Long Rest also gains Body, Mind, and Soul points equal to their Endurance, Wisdom, and Will Stat.

For example, Ahanu has an Endurance of 2, a Wisdom of 3, and a Will of 3. They take a Long Rest. Ahanu rolls a Dice Pool of 2 for their Endurance and scores 1 Success. Adding the 1 Success to their Endurance Stat of 2, they regain 3 points of Body. They roll three dice for their Wisdom, gaining 3 Successes and add 3 for their Wisdom Stat, for a total of 6 Mind gained. Finally, they roll 2 Successes on their Will Check, adding it to their Will of 3 for 5 total points of Soul. Remember that no matter how many Successes you get this way, you can't go above your normal maximum by Resting.

At the Story Guide's discretion, Characters may take a Short Rest and immediately follow it up with

a Long Rest, gaining the full benefits from both.

Healing Stat Damage

Healing from Stat Damage is much more difficult than recovering from Body, Mind, or Spirit loss and may only be done during a Long Rest. Healing from Stat Damage can regain no more than 1 point per day total from all Stats. Stats may not be healed on any day where the Character participated in an Encounter.

During a Long Rest, the Character may choose a specific Physical, Mental, or Spiritual Stat they wish to recover. Instead of making a normal Check for healing of Body, Mind or Spirit, they can instead make a Check to see if they regain 1 point of Stat. To do so, they must gain at least 1 Critical Success from their Healing Check. Failure or Critical Failure means the Character does not gain a point back. This Check only substitutes for the Healing Check. The base points gained from a Long Rest are still healed.

A Character cannot regain more points in Stat this way than they originally had before taking Damage.